

COMSATS University Islamabad

Sahiwal Campus

(Department of Computer Science)

CIVICS AND COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

Assignment # 2

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Q1. Socio-political Barriers:

In Pakistan, many people do not vote or take part in politics. There are several social and political reasons for this:

- **Lack of Education:** Many people do not understand the importance of voting. Some do not know how the system works.

- **Poverty:** Poor people are more worried about earning money than voting. They may also not have access to transport to go vote.

- **Fear and Violence:** In some areas, people are scared to vote due to threats or violence from political groups.

- **Lack of Trust:** Many citizens feel that their vote will not make a difference. They think politicians are corrupt or only care about themselves.

- **Gender Inequality:** In some areas, especially rural ones, women are not allowed or encouraged to vote.

- **Cultural Barriers:** People often vote based on family or tribal loyalty, not based on the candidate's abilities.

How to Fix These Problems:

- **Policy Changes:**

• The government should make voting easier by providing transport or mobile voting units in remote areas.

• Strict laws should be enforced to stop voter threats and fraud.

• Encourage political parties to select candidates who truly represent the people.

- Education:

• Schools and colleges should teach the importance of voting.

• Media campaigns can spread awareness about elections and political rights.

• Special programs should be made to educate women and young people about their political role.

Q2. Participatory Democracy vs. Representative:

Participatory Democracy means people are directly involved in decisions. They discuss, debate, and vote on laws or changes. It is more active and people have more control.

Representative Democracy means people vote for leaders (like MNAs or MPAs) who then make decisions for them. Most countries, including Pakistan, follow this system.

How They Work in Pakistan:

- Pakistan follows representative democracy. People vote in elections and choose leaders who sit in the parliament and make laws.

- But in real life, participatory democracy is very weak in Pakistan. Common people are not much involved after voting. They rarely take part in policy-making or local government meetings.

- Also, political parties do not always ask public opinion before making big decisions.

How to Improve:

- Strengthen local governments so people can take part in solving their community problems.

- Use digital platforms for feedback and public input.

- Encourage citizens to take part in public meetings or town halls.

Q3. Contradictions:

The Constitution of Pakistan promises many rights, such as:
- Freedom of religion
- Freedom of speech
- Freedom of press

But in reality, there are problems:

Freedom of Religion:

- The constitution allows religious freedom, but minority groups (like Hindus, Christians, Ahmadis) often face discrimination.

- Ahmadis are not allowed to call themselves Muslims. This goes against the promise of equal rights.

Freedom of Speech:

- People have the right to speak freely, but in many cases, those who criticize the government or army face threats or jail.

- Social media users are sometimes arrested for sharing opinions.

Freedom of Press:

- Pakistan has a lively media, but many journalists are attacked or silenced.

- Some TV channels and newspapers face pressure to avoid certain topics.

These contradictions show that what is written in the Constitution is not fully followed in real life.

To Solve This:

- Laws must be updated to truly protect these rights.

- Courts should give quick justice when someone’s rights are violated.

- Institutions like the media and civil society should be protected and supported.